



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:			Fuel and Oil		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Construction activities involve plant and machinery, often they contain fuel and oil. Fuel spills cause damage to the environment and harm animals, plants, fish and humans.

Use and storage

- The most commonly found fuels and oils are diesel and petrol (for engines), oil (for gearboxes) and moulds, hydraulic fluid and grease.
- Poor storage, lack of care during refuelling, vandalism and poorly maintained plant can all result in spillage.
- Even a small spill can cause damage to the environment and cause harm to animals, plants, fish and humans, as well as contaminating watercourses and groundwater.
- A spillage is likely to be expensive to clean up and there is the likelihood of prosecution and a large fine.

Controlling measures

- Ensure that bulk fuel and oil storage tanks are bunded with a capacity of 110% and kept secure (locked when not in use) and checked regularly.
- Regular monitoring arrangements should be put in place and followed to ensure control measures are fully implemented.
- All containers should be stored in secure, bunded areas.
- Refuelling should be carried out in controlled areas, where possible, and drip trays or absorbent mats placed under static plant.
- Spill kits should be available near the refuelling operation and drain covers should be provided.
- Clear up minor spillages immediately, making sure you are wearing the correct PPE and report the incident to your supervisor.
- Seek advice before attempting to dispose of fuels, oils and contaminated water or ground materials.

Precautions

- Do not pour waste or wash spillages of fuel or oil down drains.
- Do not store or carry out fuelling within ten meters of a watercourse.
- Do not allow drip trays to overflow or leave a tank to fill unsupervised.

Discussion Points

Do you know where or how to get hold of absorbent pads / spill kits in your workplace?

Do you know the correct PPE to wear when dealing with spills?